

CATEGORY		TABLETS PCS		
Brand		Toshiba	Aci	Acer
Model		Portege 3500	Tablet	Tablet
FEATURES (35%)	Processor (Type and speed)	Pentium III M 1.3 GHz	VIA Nehemiah 1 GHz	Pentium M 900 MHz
	Memory (Amount)	256 MB	256 MB	512 MB
	TFT Display Screen size (Inches)	12	14	10.4
	Hard disk (Capacity / Speed in rpm)	40 GB / 4,200	20GB / 4,200	40 GB / 4,200
	Graphics adapter	Trident CyberALADDiN-T	VIA S3G	Intel 855
	Optical drive	×	External Combo	×
	Sound card	SoundMax Digital audio	VIA AC'97	CMI AC'97
	Ports (USB/Serial/parallel/Firewire)	2 USB/×/×/✓	2USB/×/×/×	2 USB/×/×/✓
	Connectivity (IrDA,WiFi etc,LAN,Modem)	✓/✓/✓/✓	✓/×/✓/✓	✓/✓/✓/✓
	Audio-Video OUT options	Monitor D-SUB	Monitor D-SUB	D-sub
	Mouse Touch pad and No of buttons	✓ / 2	✓/2 buttons	touchpad, 2 buttons and scroll pad
	Shortcut keys on keyboard	✓	×	4 buttons, 5 tablet buttons
	Extra Batteries provided	×	×	✓
	Compact Flash slots (nos)	2	1	1
	Miscellaneous	Flash memory card reader	Memory Card Reader and External FDD	Special LCD cleaning Fabric, Extra stylus tips
	Usability (20%)			
	Dimensions (L x W x H) (mm)	295 X 234 X 32	315 x 260 x 30	250 x 215 x 28
	Weight (Kg)	2	2.5	1.5
	Extra Input Devices (wheel, pointing stick)	×	×	×
	Build Quality (S05)	3	3	2.5
	Keyboard Touch and Feel (S05)	3.5	3	3
	Mouse Touchpad sensitivity (S05)	3.5	3.5	3
	Overall Ergonomics (S05)	3	2.5	2.5
	Built-in speaker Quality test (S05)	3	3.5	3
	Temperature			
	Ambient Temp (degree Celsius)	26	26	26
	Laptop under surface (degree Celsius)	38	38	39
PACKAGING (10%)	Operating System bundled	Windows XP Professional	×	Windows XP Home Edition
	Office application suite	×	×	×
	Other software & applications provided	Toshiba control utilities	Roxio Easy CD creator and Power DVD	Tablet PC softwares
	Recovery CDs	✓	×	✓
	Accessories (carry case,docking station,etc)	Power adapter	Carrycase and power adapter	Carrycase, power adapter and extra battery
	User guide	✓	✓	✓
PERFORMANCE (35%)	Overall System benchmark			
	ZD-Bench Business winstone 2002	17.1	13.4	19.9
	Video Encoding Test (seconds)	168	277	130
	Si soft Sandra: CPU test			
	CPU Dryhstone	3,625	1,603	2,992
	CPU Whetstone	1,789	369	1,208
	Multimedia - CPU Integer	7,001	2,207	5,142
	Multimedia - FPU SSE	8,772	2,511	5,977
	Memory test			
	ALU / RAM (Int)	564	765	1,660
	FPU / RAM (Flt)	552	426	1,687
	File system test			
	Drive Index (MBps)	14,721	11,552	9,046
	Sequential Read (MBps)	22	16	12
	Random Read (MBps)	4	4	3
	Sequential Write (MBps)	19	16	12
	Random Write (MBps)	4	4	3
	Average access time (ms)	12	11	12
	Quake III Arena (fps)			
	Normal (640 x 480 x 16)	26	31	100
	High (800 x 600 x 32)	16	20	65
	Max (1024 x 768 x 32)	8	14	36
	3D Mark2001 SE			
	Displaymate assorted file test (S05)	3	3	3
	MobileMark 2002 Battery Test	2 Hrs 10 Min	2 Hrs 13 Min	2 Hrs 20 Min
OVERALL SCORE	Performance (35%)	24.90	22.22	28.06
	Features (35%)	18.90	16.50	21.40
	Usability (20%)	11.90	10.30	12.40
	Package content (10%)	6.50	4.00	6.00
	Overall	62.20	53.02	67.86
OTHER	Value for money	1.8	4.5	2.5
	Grade			
	Price (Rs)	2,04,999	69,990	1,59,990

Apple G4 powerbook

One look at the new Apple PowerBook, and you're sure to fall in love with it. Apple products are known for their unique styling, and this baby is no exception; everything spells pizzaz.



Discarding the old titanium cover, the G4 is dressed in silver-coloured aluminium casing. Tipping the scales at 2.6 Kgs, it's slightly heavy, but not uncomfortably so. The wide 15-inch LCD is more than enough, and a DVI connector offers connection to any external digital monitor, or projection device. The plethora of connectivity options available on the PowerBook is something to talk about—two USB 2.0 ports, a standard (IEEE 1394) FireWire and another FireWire 800 (IEEE 1394b). This was the only laptop with an IEEE 1394b port. Similarly, the PowerBook has a high speed Gigabit Ethernet connector, a phone jack (RJ-11) and an optional Airport Extreme card for wireless connectivity.

The slot loading SuperDrive is a boon to the mobile user—just slide in the CD, and go about your business. The backlight disregards poor lighting conditions, and sensors detect the ambient light and adjust the backlight—of the LCD and the keyboard—accordingly. The only disappointment came in the form of the jerky trackpad.

Under the sleek hood, is a G4 1.25 GHz processor and 512 MB RAM. Mac OS X version 10.2.5 combines the ease of use of a Mac, with the stability of Unix, and has almost every imaginable application pre-installed—iTunes, iMovie, iDVD, speech recognition software, etc. The system lasted only two hours and 40 minutes on a full charge.

At close to Rs 1.77 lakh, this stunner is sure to wrench your heart out through your wallet. But once you have it, remember to flaunt it at every possible occasion!